

Supplementary Note on Local Transport Expense Reimbursement Standards for US Urban Transport Policy Research

XX Institute Finance [2024] No. 12

To all departments and research groups:

In accordance with the "Employee Business Travel Reimbursement Management Measures" (XX Institute Finance [2024] No. 3) and based on the actual work needs of the "Comparative Study on China-US Urban Transport Policy" research group (Project No.: TRP-2024-008) for the US research trip, the following supplementary note on local transport expense reimbursement standards is hereby issued after deliberation:

I. Background

This US research trip involves intensive research visits in Washington D.C. and Boston. According to the itinerary submitted by the project team, on March 10, 2024, two different institution visits were arranged in Washington D.C. in the morning and afternoon. Although the two venues were not far apart, the schedule was tight. In addition, the morning research activity ended late while the afternoon activity started early, making it necessary to use relatively expensive high-end express car services. On March 11, a department visit was arranged in the morning and an academic seminar in the afternoon, after which the team needed to immediately proceed to the airport for Boston. The itinerary was also very tight. During the Boston research period, academic institutions were distributed in different areas of the city with insufficient public transport coverage; conventional bus and subway lines could not directly reach the research locations.

After evaluation by the relevant superior department, the above situations during the city research period were indeed confirmed to exist.

II. Reimbursement Standard Adjustment

In view of the above objective circumstances, and with the approval of the Institute Affairs Meeting, the local transport expense reimbursement standards for this US research trip (March 8 to March 13, 2024) are adjusted as follows:

1. The individual reimbursement cap for local transport expenses (including taxi fares, ride-hailing platform fees, etc.) during this research trip is hereby removed. Local transport expenses incurred by project team members for official activities shall be reimbursed based on actual costs with valid electronic trip sheets or platform electronic receipts, and shall no longer be

subject to the general local transport expense limits stipulated in the "Employee Business Travel Reimbursement Management Measures";

2. The above adjustment applies only to local transport expenses incurred during the US research trip (March 8 to March 13, 2024) by the "Comparative Study on China-US Urban Transport Policy" research group, and does not apply to other business trips;

3. Local transport expense reimbursement shall still meet the following basic conditions:

(1) The expenses must be reasonable local transport expenditures incurred for official activities;

(2) Electronic trip sheets or electronic receipts issued by ride-hailing platforms or taxi companies must be provided. The trip sheet should contain complete information including origin, destination, date, time, mileage, cost breakdown, and payment record;

(3) The transport itinerary must have a reasonable temporal and spatial correspondence with the research activities in the itinerary;

(4) Reimbursement materials must be reviewed and confirmed by the department head before submission to the finance department for re-verification.

III. Approval Note

This supplementary note was applied for by the project leader, reviewed by the Transport Policy Research Center, re-verified by the Finance Department, and approved by the responsible institute leader. The approval process was fully completed on March 16, 2024.

IV. Other Matters

1. This adjustment to local transport expense reimbursement standards does not affect the provisions of the "Employee Business Travel Reimbursement Management Measures" regarding accommodation expenses, meal expenses, and other expense reimbursement standards. The above expenses shall still be executed according to the original standards;

2. Project team members should use local transport services in a frugal and economical manner, and shall not incur unnecessary transport expenditures due to the removal of the cap;

3. When reviewing reimbursement materials, the finance department will focus on verifying the correspondence between transport itineraries and research activities, and has the right to request explanations from travelers for transport expenses that obviously deviate from official activity routes or times;

4. This supplementary note has equal effect to the "Employee Business Travel Reimbursement Management Measures". In case of any inconsistency, this supplementary note shall prevail;

5. This supplementary note shall take effect from the date of issuance, and the right of interpretation belongs to the Institute Finance Department.

China XX Research Institute Finance Department March 16, 2024